

## Android Market more unified as the Google Play Store



Google is taking a leaf out of Apple and Amazon's book by unifying its digital content under one roof for Android devices. Called the Google Play Store instead of the Android Market, the store will bring you Google Music, Movies and the Google Books

in addition to the existing library of apps.

Users will be able to manage their content with greater ease and an app downloaded on one Google-powered device will reflect on your other Google-powered devices thanks to the power of the cloud (sounds like iCloud?).

Users will be able to store 20,000 music files on the cloud. You can store both, the files you purchased from the Google Play Store and your own collection. You can't store movies though.

The expansion of the library will help Android device users find a larger variety of content in one place making it a one-stop shop for apps, books, music and movies. Since the service is new, Google will offer special deals to attract customers to explore the new offerings.

The marketplace has over 45,000 mobile apps and Google plans to add four million books including free titles and over 13 million songs and movies to the Google Play Store. **[i]**

## Google in punishment mode

Google will penalise web sites that are overly optimised (with excessive keywords or link exchanges) for better search results. The search engine giant is currently working on a new set of tweaks to its "GoogleBot" that will identify such web sites.

SearchEngineLand.com quoted Google's Matt Cutts as saying that the web sites with great content are far more deserving for rankings than the sites with average content but backed by a better job with SEO.

Google's recent semantic search capabilities will help it directly answer users' questions and search queries instead of providing list of sites that might have the information they seek. **[i]**

## I&B Ministry joins Facebook

The Ministry of Information and Broadcasting has decided to use the power of social media to address issues related to digitalisation. The ministry has created a Facebook account, through which it also aims to have more direct communication with the key stakeholders. The Facebook account is likely to help the ministry create more awareness among public about its policies and take up a wide range of public concerns.

The ministry's Facebook account features answers to some of the frequently asked queries and also pro-

vides users with direct links to other organisations associated with digitisation. The government officials hope that the ministry will now efficiently deal with stakeholders such as multi-system operators and cable operators as well as serve as a source of information for individuals.

It's learnt that the ministry plans to complete the digitisation of the Cable sector by December 31, 2014. In the first phase of the plan, the ministry will digitise services in the four metropolitan cities of Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai and Kolkata by June 30 this year. **[i]**

## Web censorship row update

In a major relief to the internet companies locked in the web censorship row, the Delhi High Court has rejected charges of hosting offensive content against Microsoft India. The HC accepted Microsoft India's plea that the company didn't provide material to users to interact with each other or post their views. The court further asked the complainant Vinay Rai to file a fresh complaint if he comes across any credible evidence against the web site.

Earlier, Rai had moved the trial court against as many as 21 web sites including Microsoft,

Facebook, Google and YouTube for allegedly hosting offensive content. Metropolitan Magistrate Sudesh Kumar had issued summons to the companies to face the charges of hosting obscene content punishable under IPC 292 (sale of obscene books and material) and 293 (sale of obscene objects to young person).

The court, in one of its initial hearings, had warned of bringing in a China-like ban on the internet. The government has already asked the Internet companies to set up a proper monitoring mechanism on social networks. **[i]**